

KALE REALTY

51% OF HOMES SOLD **OVER** ASKING.

The same week the national market posted its weakest month since January.

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**YOUR BUYERS ARE
READING A
NATIONAL
"MARKET IS
COOLING"
HEADLINE. COOK
COUNTY DIDN'T
GET IT.**

National pending contracts fell 2.3% in July. Cook County is still a bidding-war market.

TWO DIFFERENT MARKETS, ONE HEADLINE.

NAR's July report put the national Pending Home Sales Index at 71.2, the lowest reading since January 2026, down 2.3% month over month. Cook County ran the opposite direction: 51.3% of homes sold above list price, and the median sale price climbed to \$398,875, up 6.4% year over year. Chicago proper is doing its part too, with only 2.8 months of available supply. The national story is a slowdown. The local story is still short inventory and buyers competing.

WHAT THIS CHANGES ABOUT THE NEXT APPOINTMENT:

1 Stop letting the national headline set the buyer's expectations.

A buyer who read "housing is cooling" needs the local number, not a rebuttal. Fifty-one percent of Cook County homes sold above list last month.

2 Set up sellers for competing offers on well-priced listings.

With 2.8 months of supply in the city, a correctly priced home is still landing in front of more than one buyer.

3 Use the 6.4% year-over-year price move in the listing presentation.

It is the specific, current answer to "should I wait for prices to drop."

THE TAKEAWAY

LEAD WITH COOK COUNTY'S NUMBER, NOT THE NATIONAL ONE.

Your local market is telling a different story than the headline your buyer just read.